DARREN HEADLEY

DIRECTOR OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

CONTACT

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LOCATION
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github.com/ZeroZenx

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure
AWS, Azure, GCP, Linux, VOIP

Development
Python, PHP, JavaScript, React, HTML5, CSS3

Data & Database
SQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Data Analysis

Platforms & Tools
Moodle, Drupal, WordPress, Git, CI/CD, SOC, IDS

EDUCATION

MSc Artificial Intelligence
University of York | 2025

BSc Computer Science
University of Southampton | 2003

CERTIFICATIONS

NCP-MCI

CAIE

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A results-driven technology executive with 20+ years of experience leading digital transformation, cybersecurity operations, cloud infrastructure, and enterprise platform modernisation across higher education and corporate sectors. Currently serving as Director of Information Technology at COSTAATT, where I drive AI integration, institutional automation, and strategic IT governance. Known for translating complex technology challenges into scalable, outcome-oriented solutions that improve reliability, responsiveness, and institutional decision-making.

Digital Transformation | AI & Automation Strategy | Cybersecurity Operations | Cloud Infrastructure | IT Governance | Team Leadership | Project Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Information Technology

COSTAATT | *January 2023 – Present*

- Spearheading institution-wide digital transformation, including AI integration across teaching, learning, and administrative operations — launching AI pilots in registry, admissions, and faculty engagement.
- Overseeing multi-layered cybersecurity operations encompassing SOC, IDS, firewall governance, and security awareness programmes.
- Led the strategic Moodle LMS upgrade to version 4.0, delivering enhanced digital learning capabilities and driving adoption across faculty and student populations.
- Managing a comprehensive college-wide digital redesign initiative in collaboration with senior executives, improving student services and governance processes.
- Directed large-scale VOIP infrastructure upgrades across academic departments.
- Architected automation systems for student document processing, transcript workflows, admissions tracking, and operational reporting — significantly reducing manual processing time.

CompTIA A+ & Network+

Linux+

ITIL Foundation v1/v3

ITIL Service Strategy

HP ATA – Connected Devices

- Built a cyberbullying monitoring dashboard integrated with institutional security platforms.

Information Technology Supervisor

COSTAATT / *January 2006 – December 2022*

- Led a 25-member technical team ensuring campus-wide connectivity, enterprise infrastructure stability, and consistent service delivery.
- Managed technical support, systems administration, and network monitoring and configuration across multiple campuses.
- Directed major IT projects spanning digital transformation, cybersecurity, information security policy, and regulatory compliance.
- Designed and delivered training programmes for staff on modern technologies and best practices.
- Coordinated comprehensive server infrastructure upgrades to support institutional growth.

Help Desk / Support Technician / Analyst

Software Technology Ltd. / *January 2005 – December 2005*

- Delivered technical support, ensured data integrity, and provided development team leadership on key client-facing projects.

Helpdesk Analyst

Scotiabank / *January 2003 – December 2004*

- Delivered desktop support, software configuration, and timely incident resolution in a high-volume banking environment.

Assistant System Administrator

Hadico Limited / *January 2002 – December 2002*

- Assisted in network setup, VOIP deployment, and end-user technical support across the organisation.

STRATEGIC INITIATIVES

AI Adoption Strategy: Defined and implemented institutional AI strategy for academic and administrative operations.

AI Inbox Automation: Automated institutional email workflows to improve response efficiency.

Transcript Automation Workflow: Eliminated manual transcript processing through a dedicated automation system.

Recruitment CRM: Developed a CRM system for admissions pipeline management.

LMS Modernisation Programme: Led institution-wide upgrade of Moodle LMS to v4.0.

Operational Reporting Systems: Delivered automated internal reporting for leadership visibility and faster decision-making.